CROTTIN DE CHAVIGNOL PDO



THE BASICS

MAKE:	Soft
SUB MAKE:	Predominantly Lactic set cheese or further ripening
POST-MAKE:	External mould/yeast ripened
SUB POST-MAKE:	Vermiculated rind - predominantly yeast
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Minimum 10 days, but typically two months.
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	60g
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Sancerre, France
PROTECTED STATUS:	PDO – must be made with raw goats' milk in the Cher, Loiret and Nièvre departments
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Goat
BREED OF GOAT:	Alpine
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Raw goats' milk
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Typically animal rennet
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	N/A

THE STORY

Crottin de Chavignol encapsulates the Loire Valley's reputation as a hot bed of goats cheese and wine production. Vineyards in the region raised goats and made cheese as far back as the 16th century and Crottin is believed to derive from the word crot – a small oil lamp that would be used to light wine cellars. Crottin also means 'dung', which could be a reference to the cheese's rustic appearance. Chavignol is a town in the region.

Production follows the soft cheese process, however it is a lactic cheese coagulated over several hours predominantly by the acidification of the milk, plus a small quantity of rennet. The curds are pre-drained before moulding. They are turned at least once during draining and are dry-salted after unmoulding. The maturation temperature must be above 10°C.

THE CHARACTER

The rind varies from ivory white to brown in younger cheeses with a coat of blue and grey mould developing as it matures. The texture also changes from smooth and moist to dry and crumbly. Typical flavours include dairy, floral and earthy notes

PERFECT PARTNERS:

Sancerre (made with sauvignon blanc grapes) is a classic combination.

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